

# Benjamin C. Bates

Harvard Law School, Program on Corporate Governance

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## ACADEMIC POSITIONS

### Harvard Law School

*Research and Teaching Fellow*, Program on Corporate Governance, 2023–present

Research Assistant to Professors Lucian Bebchuk and Alma Cohen

Teaching Fellow to Professor Lucian Bebchuk

Courses: Corporate & Capital Markets Law & Policy (Fall 2023, 2024, 2025)  
Stakeholder Capitalism (Fall 2023, 2024, 2025)

## EDUCATION

### Harvard Law School

J.D., *magna cum laude*, 2023

Awards: John M. Olin Writing Prize in Law and Economics  
Hyun Park Fellowship in Law and Economics

Honors: Dean's Scholar Prizes in Contracts, Torts, Legislation and  
Regulation, Empirical Law & Finance Seminar, Mergers &  
Acquisitions Workshop, and Global Antitrust

Activities: *Harvard Law Review*, Editor

### Brigham Young University

B.S., *magna cum laude* in Finance, 2020

Japanese Minor

## TEACHING/RESEARCH INTERESTS

**Primary:** Business Associations, Securities Regulation, Contracts, Corporate Finance, Torts

**Secondary:** Financial Institutions, Antitrust, Law and Economics

## PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

*Retail Access to Private Markets: What Are the Risks?* (2025) (job market paper)

Featured on [ProMarket](#), [Bloomberg](#), [Fund Board Views](#), [TEBI](#), [Connect Money](#),  
[The Lever](#), [HLS Forum on Corp. Gov.](#)

Cited in a [speech by SEC Commissioner Crenshaw](#)

*Rewriting the Rules for Corporate Elections*, 100 NYU L. REV. 635 (2025)

Featured on [Bloomberg Law](#), [Shareholder Primacy Podcast](#), [The Activist Investor](#), [DealLawyers.com](#), [HLS Forum on Corp. Gov.](#)

Cited in [Wright v. Farello](#), No. 2024-0306, 2025 WL 3012956 (Del. Ch. Oct. 27, 2025)

*Is SEC Registration Costly for Private Fund Advisers?* (2025)

Featured on [HLS Forum on Corp. Gov.](#)

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

*Delayed Shareholder Votes* (with J. Frankenreiter)

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

### **Harvard Law School**

Corporate & Capital Markets Law & Policy (Teaching Fellow to Professor Lucian Bebchuk)

Stakeholder Capitalism (Teaching Fellow to Professor Lucian Bebchuk)

Contracts (Teaching Fellow to Professor Oren Bar-Gill)

### **Brigham Young University**

Investments (Teaching Assistant to Professors Darren Aiello and Brian Boyer)

Financial Derivatives (Teaching Assistant to Professor Todd Mitton)

## PRESENTATIONS

### **Retail Access to Private Markets: What Are the Risks?**

USC Corporate & Commercial Law Seminar, Los Angeles, CA (February 2026)

Massachusetts Securities Division, Boston, MA (January 2026)

AALS Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA (January 2026)

Miami Law & Finance Workshop, Virtual (November 2025)

Conference on Empirical Legal Studies, Washington, DC (October 2025)

HLS Law & Economics Seminar, Cambridge, MA (October 2025)

National Business Law Scholars Conference, Los Angeles, CA (June 2025)

HLS Program on Corporate Governance Workshop, Cambridge, MA (June 2025)

### **Rewriting the Rules for Corporate Elections**

American Law and Economics Association, New York, NY (May 2025)

NYU Institute for Corporate Governance & Finance Spring Roundtable, New York, NY (May 2025)

HLS Law, Economics, & Organizations Seminar, Cambridge, MA (November 2024)

National Business Law Scholars Conference, Davis, CA (June 2024)

HLS Program on Corporate Governance Workshop, Cambridge, MA (January 2024)

**Is SEC Registration Costly for Private Fund Advisers?**

Conference on Empirical Legal Studies, Atlanta, GA (November 2024)

American Law and Economics Association, Ann Arbor, MI (May 2024)

HLS Law & Economics Seminar, Cambridge, MA (March 2023)

HLS Program on Corporate Governance Workshop, Cambridge, MA (March 2023)

**OTHER EMPLOYMENT**

**Wilmer Cutler Pickering Hale & Dorr LLP**

*Summer Associate, 2022*

**U.S. Attorney's Office, District of Massachusetts**

*Intern, Securities, Financial, and Cyber Fraud Unit, 2021*

**SKILLS**

**Languages:** Japanese (conversational)

**Programming:** R, Python, LaTeX

**BAR ADMISSION**

Massachusetts (2023–present)

## REFERENCES

### **Lucian Bebachuk**

Harvard Law School  
617-495-3138  
bebachuk@law.harvard.edu

### **Jared Ellias**

Harvard Law School  
617-496-4245  
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### **Steven Shavell**

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### **Howell Jackson**

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### **Alma Cohen**

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